the Gupta pillar there, have elements modelled on the Ashokan pillar.[21] These commemorations in stone help preserve memory of the emperor, though once Ashoka himself starts being engraved as a figure in sculptural reliefs he assumes an even clearer historical shape which then grows into his best-known avatara. Interestingly, in modern India it is the connection between the Bodhi tree and the women in Ashoka's life which continues as a popular leitmotif among artists, especially in the works of those who were part of the Indian nationalist art movement. Tishyarakshita looking at the Bodhi tree, for instance, was painted by Abanindranath Tagore, while Nandlal Bose and Upendra Maharathi drew Sanghamitra carrying the Bodhi tree to Sri Lanka.